increasingly found themselves at loggerheads, whether it comes to terrorism, export control regimes, freedom of navigation, or UN Security Council reform.

While the boundary dispute and regional security differences have been long-standing concerns, bilateral economic ties and multilateral affairs until recently represented two areas of potential convergence and cooperation between New Delhi and Beijing. But in recent years, all four areas of India–China relations have witnessed a widening disparity in interests and perspectives. Due to geographic, historical, economic, and political factors, India is at the forefront in bearing the brunt of China's newfound assertiveness. There may continue to be issues on which both India and China find convergence, and there may also be times when both sides decide to tactically recalibrate the relationship. But unless China adopts a fundamentally different approach to its role in international affairs, New Delhi will have to continue to prepare for a much more competitive relationship with Beijing.

India's concerns about China have resulted in its Act East Policy in the Indo–Pacific. The Look East Policy, which began in the early 1990s, had a primarily economic focus. But in the mid-2000s—just as economic relations between India and China were taking off—renewed concerns about China began to feature as a bigger factor in India's eastward engagement. [14] As a result, relations with Southeast and North-East India became more comprehensive, with a more pronounced security focus. The geographical scope of India's eastward engagement also became wider, extending from the Indian Ocean to the Western and Southern Pacific, as China's own influence expanded. This in turn required India to imagine a larger neighbourhood: the Indo–Pacific. Third, increased urgency in responding to China's actions necessitated more activity, clearer deliverables, and shorter timelines. These three important features—a bigger security focus, larger geographical spread, and stronger delivery—resulted in a new name: Act East. If the original objective of the Look East Policy was primarily to accelerate India's economic development, the